

Kelsea Schulenberg, PhD

Curriculum Vitae

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Education

- 2021–Dec. 2025 **Ph.D., Human Centered Computing**, GPA: 4.00, Clemson University, Clemson, South Carolina - Advisor: Dr. Guo Freeman
Dissertation Title: *AI In Consideration of Her: Accounting for Gendered Workplace Dynamics in the Design and Evaluation of Human-Centered AI Integration in Everyday Workplaces*
- 2019–2021 **M.A., Communication, Technology, and Society**, GPA: 4.00, Clemson University, Clemson, South Carolina - Advisor: Dr. Erin M. Ash
Thesis Title: *"You're in a Cult, Call Your Dad." An Investigation Into the True Crime Podcast My Favorite Murder and Its Online Fan Communities*
- 2013–2017 **B.S., Psychology**, Clemson University, Clemson, South Carolina
- Spring 2016 **Minor, Global Politics**, University of Belgrade, Faculty of Political Science, Belgrade, Serbia

Work Experience

- Summer 2025 **Clemson University, Office of University Compliance and Ethics, Graduate Student Worker.**
- Worked alongside Clemson University's Chief Privacy Officer to develop and draft university-level policies and practices for HIPAA compliance and AI use.
- 2024–Present **Clemson University, School of Computing, Graduate Teaching Assistant.**
- Assignment grading, student advisement, and course instruction as needed to assist professor or lead course.
 - **Fall 2025:** CPSC2921: Computing, Ethics, and Society Recitation, *Lead Instructor*; HCC4300/6300: Game Development, *Dr. Guo Freeman*.
 - **Spring 2025:** HCC8500: Science of Teamwork and Technology, *Dr. Nathan McNeese*; CPSC4/6820: Web Accessibility, *Dr. Emma Dixon*.
 - **Fall 2024:** CPSC4/6820: Game Design and HCC 8330: Research Methods for Human-Centered Computing, *Dr. Guo Freeman*
- 2022–2024 **Clemson University, Clemson University Gaming and Mediated Experience (CUGAME) Lab, Graduate Research Assistant.**
- Lead Ph.D. student researching harassment in social Virtual Reality (VR), specifically investigating minority individuals' (i.e., women, LGBTQ+, ethnic minorities, etc.) experiences with harassment and strategies for mitigating harassment.

- 2021 Summer-Fall **Clemson University, Team Research and Analytics in Computational Environments (TRACE) Research Group, *Graduate Research Assistant*.**
- Researched perceptions of bias and bias mitigation in the context of Artificial Intelligence (AI) system development amongst military and civilian contractors, a project funded by the Department of Defense (DOD).
- 2019–2021 **Clemson University, Department of Communication, *Graduate Teaching Assistant*.**
- Independently taught one section of COMM 1501 - Introduction to Communication Laboratory per semester, focusing on instructing students in the practice and performance of public speaking.
- 2019–2021 **Clemson University, Clemson Debate Society, Department of Communication, *Graduate Assistant Debate Coach*.**
- Coached a cohort of competitors in competitive collegiate Worlds-Style debate, as well as traveled nationally and internationally with the team to instruct and judge debates.
- 2019 **Dority & Manning, P.A., *Intellectual Property Specialist*.**
- Lead Specialist in implementing change management of over 500 national and international patent cases from a Fortune 500 multinational conglomerate's in-house legal team to Dority & Manning, P.A.'s legal team, amongst other varied legal assistant duties.
- 2017-2018 **Dority & Manning, P.A., *Junior Legal Assistant*.**
- Crafted and maintained patent file cases for a Fortune 500 multinational conglomerate, amongst other clerical and administrative duties.

Research Interests

Human-Artificial Intelligence (AI) Collaboration, AI in the Workforce, Women in the Workforce, Human-Centered Computing (HCC), Feminist HCI, Women and AI, Computer-Mediated Communication (CMC), Social Virtual Reality (VR), Harassment and Online Safety for Minority Individuals

Research Skills

- Data Collection** Experimental Design, Interviewing, Focus Groups, Usability Testing, Survey Design, Observation, Affordance Design, A/B Testing, Content Analysis
- Data Analysis** ANOVA, Linear Mixed Effects Modeling, Grounded Theory, Thematic Analysis, Interpretivist Phenomenological Analysis
- Tools** Qualtrics, Prolific, R, Stata, SPSS, Figma, LaTeX

Publications

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

- 🏆 [J.8] Freeman, G., Li, L., & **Schulenberg, K.** (2025). "I Have Abused Someone Who Abused Me": Understanding People Who Have Experienced Both Sides of Harassment Accusations in Social VR. In *Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction (PACM HCI)*, CSCW. ***Best Paper Honorable Mention Award: Top 3%***
- [J.7] **Schulenberg, K.**, Freeman, G., Li, L., & Knijnenburg, B. (2024). Does Who You Are or Appear to Be Matter?: Understanding Identity-Based Harassment in Social VR Through the Lens of (Mis)Perceived Identity Revelation. In *Proceedings of the ACM on Human Computer Interaction (PACM HCI)*, CSCW.
- [J.6] Lancaster, C. M., **Schulenberg, K.**, Flathmann, C., McNeese, N. J., & Freeman, G. (2023). "It's Everybody's Role to Speak Up... But Not Everyone Will": Understanding AI Professionals' Perceptions of Accountability for AI Bias Mitigation. *ACM Journal on Responsible Computing*, (oct 2023), 28 pages. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3632121>.
- 🏆 [J.5] **Schulenberg, K.**, Li, L., Lancaster, C., Zytke, D., & Freeman, G. (2023). "We Don't Want a Bird Cage, We Want Guardrails": Understanding & Designing for Preventing Interpersonal Harm in Social VR through the Lens of Consent. In *Proceedings of the ACM on Human Computer Interaction (PACM HCI)*, 7, CSCW2, Article 323 (oct 2023), 30 pages. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3610172>. ***Best Paper Honorable Mention Award: Top 3%***
- 🏆 [J.4] **Schulenberg, K.**, Freeman, G., Li, L., & Barwulor, C. (2023). "Creepy Towards My Avatar Body, Creepy Towards My Body": How Women Experience and Manage Harassment Risks in Social Virtual Reality. In *Proceedings of the ACM on Human Computer Interaction (PACM HCI)*, 7, CSCW2, Article 236 (oct 2023), 29 pages. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3610027> ***Best Paper Honorable Mention Award: Top 3%***
- [J.3] Ash, E., **Schulenberg, K.**, Wilson, M., & Mikkilineni, S. (2023). Framing Risk and Responsibility: Newspaper Coverage of COVID-19 Racial Disparities. *Newspaper Research Journal*, 44(2), pages 174-189. <https://doi.org/10.1177/07395329231167368>.
- [J.2] Ash, E., Xu, Y., Pool, R., **Schulenberg, K.**, Mikkilineni, S. D., & Baraka, T. (2023). Exemplification Effects on Policy Support: Exemplar Familiarity, Narrative Vividness, and Perceptions of Maternal Health Disparities. *Health Communication*, 1-14. <https://doi.org/10.1080/10410236.2023.2200907>
- 🏆 [J.1] Freeman, G., Acena, D., McNeese, N.J., & **Schulenberg, K.** (2022). Working Together Apart through Embodiment: Engaging in Everyday Collaborative Activities in Social Virtual Reality. *Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction*. 6, GROUP, Article 17 (January 2022), 25 pages. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3492836>. ***Best Paper Honorable Mention Award (Top 5%)***

Peer-Reviewed Conference Papers

- [C.8] Freeman, G., **Schulenberg, K.**, Li, L., Panchanadikar, R., & McNeese, N. (2025). "Comforting and Small Like a House Cat, Big and Intimidating Like a Bodyguard": How Women Perceive and Envision AI Companions as a New Harassment Mitigation Approach in Social VR. In *Proceedings of the 2025 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI'25)*, ACM, pp.1-16.
- [C.7] Freeman, G.**, Hu, Y.**, Panchanadikar, R., Hall, A. L., **Schulenberg, K.**, & Li, L. (2024). "My Audience Gets to Know Me on a More Realistic Level": Exploring Social VR Streamers' Unique Strategies to Engage with Their Audiences. In *Extended Abstracts of the CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI EA '24)*, ACM, New York, NY, USA, 8 pages.
- [C.6] Panchanadikar, R., Freeman, G., Li, L.**, **Schulenberg, K.**,** & Hu, Y. (2024). "A New Golden Era" or "Slap Comps": How Non-Profit Driven Indie Game Developers Perceive the Emerging Role of Generative AI in Game Development. In *Extended Abstracts of the CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI EA '24)*, ACM, New York, NY, USA, 7 pages.
- [C.5] **Schulenberg, K.**, Li, L., Freeman, G., Zamanifard, S., & McNeese, N.J. (2023). Towards Leveraging AI-based Moderation to Address Emergent Harassment in Social Virtual Reality. In *Proceedings of the 2023 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*. 1–17.
- 🏆 [C.4] Li, L., Freeman, G., **Schulenberg, K.**, & Acena, D. (2023). "We Cried on Each Other's Shoulders": How LGBTQ+ Individuals Experience Social Support in Social Virtual Reality. In *Proceedings of the 2023 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*. ***Best Paper Honorable Mention Award (Top 3%)***
- [C.3] Freeman, G., Li, L., McNeese, N.J., & **Schulenberg, K.** (2023). Understanding and Mitigating Challenges for Non-Profit Driven Indie Game Development to Innovate Game Production. In *Proceedings of the 2023 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*.
- [C.2] Schlesener, E. A., Lancaster, C., Barwulor, C., Murmu, C., & **Schulenberg, K.** (2023). TitleX: Step Up & Step In! A Mobile Augmented Reality Game Featuring Interactive Embodied Conversational Agents for Sexual Assault Bystander Intervention Training on US College Campuses. *Extended Abstracts of the 2023 ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI'23)*.
- 🏆 [C.1] **Schulenberg, K.**, Hauptman, A.I., Schlesener, E.A., Watkins, H., & Freeman, G. (2023). "I Felt Like I Wasn't Really Meant to be There": Understanding Women's Perceptions of Gender in Approaching AI Design & Development. The 2023 Hawaii International Conference on System Sciences (HICSS 2023). <https://hdl.handle.net/10125/102650> ***Best Paper Nomination Award***

** indicates co-authorship

Master's Thesis

Schulenberg, K. (April 2021). "You're in a Cult, Call Your Dad." An Investigation Into the True Crime Podcast *My Favorite Murder* and Its Online Fan Communities. Committee: Erin M. Ash, Kristen Okamoto, D. Travers Scott, Guo Freeman

Presentations

Invited Corporate Talks & Presentations

- [CT.5] "Plot Twists & Power Moves: Career Stories From Women at Every Stage" (October 2025) - Discussion Panelist. *Carolina Women+ In Tech, Greenville, SC.*
- [CT.4] "Centering Human Experiences as the Core of Tech Design" (June 2024) - 1st Inaugural Science Café Scientist Speaker. *Women, Life, and Science Presents: Science Café, Greenville, SC.*
- [CT.3] "Navigating the Minefield of Your Early Career" (April 2024) - Round Table 1 Discussion Panelist. *Women, Life, and Science Conference 2024, Greenville, SC.*
- [CT.2] "The Beauty of Uncertainty is Infinite Possibility" (April 2024) - Main Stage Panelist, Early Career. *Women, Life, and Science Conference 2024, Greenville, SC.*
- [CT.1] "Is Grad School Right for Me?" (March 2024) - Presenter. *#ImpactTheFuture Google's Women Techmakers Celebration: Tampa, Tampa, FL*

Invited Academic Talks & Guest Lectures

- [I.4] "Ethics & AI: Gender, Workplace Dynamics, & (maybe) Space?!" (September 2025) - Multi-Day Invited Guest Lecture Series for CPSC2920: Computing, Ethics, and Society Lecture, *Clemson University, Clemson, SC.*
- [I.3] "AI Design Intermingling with Women's Working Lives: A Study of Women in AI Development and Research" (March 2024) - Invited Guest Presentation for Information Science Ph.D. Student Seminar Series, *Cornell University, Ithaca, NY.*
- [I.2] "Virtual Reality and HCI" (2023) - Invited Guest Lecture in COMM 8230: Media Effects, *Clemson University, Clemson, SC.*
- [I.1] "Women in Video Game Production" (2022) - Invited Guest Lecture in COMM 3160: Media and Social Identities, *Clemson University, Clemson, SC.*

Non-Archival Academic Conference Presentations

- [P.2] Ash, E., **Schulenberg, K.**, Wilson, M., & Mikkilineni, S. (2021). Framing Risk and Responsibility: Newspaper Coverage of COVID-19 Racial Disparities. *71st Annual International Communication Association (ICA) Conference.*
- [P.1] Baraka, T., Ash, E., **Schulenberg, K.**, Mikkilineni, S., Wilson, M., Sierra-Rivera, J., & Pool, R.. (2021). Exemplification Effects on Policy Support: Exemplar Liking, Narrative Vividness, and Perceptions of Maternal Health Disparities. *71st Annual International Communication Association (ICA) Conference.*

Fellowships and Awards

Fellowships

2023-2025 Clemson University **College of Engineering, Computing and Applied Sciences (CECAS) Dean's Fellowship** Fellow

2021-2023 Clemson University **Clemson Graduate Fellowship** Fellow

Peer-Reviewed Publication Awards

2025 1 Best Paper Honorable Mention Awards (Top 3%) - CSCW 2025

2023 2 Best Paper Honorable Mention Awards (Top 3%) - CSCW 2023

2023 Best Paper Honorable Mention Award (Top 3%) - CHI 2023

2023 Best Paper Honorable Mention Award (Top 5%) - GROUP 2023

2023 Best Paper Nomination Award - HICSS 2023

Special Recognition for Outstanding Review

2024 4 recognitions for CHI 2024 Papers

2023 1 recognition for CHI PLAY 2023 Full Papers

2023 3 recognitions for CSCW 2023 January 2023

2023 1 recognition for CHI 2023 Papers

2022 1 recognition for NordiCHI 2022 Papers

Relevant Coursework

Computing & Technology

- Explainability and Fairness in AI
- Human-Computer Interaction
- Fundamentals of Human-Centered Computing
- Usable Privacy and Security
- Computing and Online Relationships
- Game Design
- Survey of Communication Technology Studies

Research Methodology

- Research Methods for Human-Centered Computing
- Quantitative Methods
- Qualitative Methods

Teaching & Mentoring Experience

Courses Taught

- 2020-2021 **COMM 1501 Introduction to Human Communications** - 1 Section Fall 2020 & 1 Section Spring 2021. *Graduate Teaching Assistant, Department of Communication, **Clemson University**.*
- 2019-2020 **COMM 1501 Introduction to Human Communications** - 1 Section Fall 2019 & 1 Section Spring 2020. *Graduate Teaching Assistant, Department of Communication, **Clemson University**.*

Collegiate Coaching

- 2019-2021 **Clemson Debate Society** - Internationally competitive Worlds-Style collegiate debate team. *Graduate Assistant Debate Coach, **Clemson University***
- Team Places* Vanderbilt Debating Championship 2021 Open Semi-Finalists / University of Vermont Debating Championship 2020 Grand Finalists & Open Semi-Finalists / U.S. *During*
- Tenure:* Universities Eastern Debating Championship 2020 Grand Final Winners & Novice Grand Final Winners / Vanderbilt 2020 BP Tournament Quarter-Finalists & Semi-Finalists / United States Air Force Academy 2019 Debate Championship Winners / University of North Georgia 2019 Debate Tournament Winners & Novice Finalists

Student Mentoring

- 2020-2021 **Master in Communication, Technology, and Society (MACTS) Second Year Peer Mentor** - Rebecca Pool, Ph.D. Human Factors Psychology, *Clemson University, Fall 2022 - Present*

Professional Activities

Reviewing

Journals

- Proceedings of ACM on Human-Computer Interaction, CSCW, since 2022
- Proceedings of ACM on Human-Computer Interaction, CHI PLAY, since 2023

Conferences

- The ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI), Student Research Competition, since 2024
- The ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI), since 2022
- Hawaii International Conference on System Sciences (HICSS), since 2022
- NordiCHI, since 2022

Professional Affiliations

- ACM, since 2022
- ACM SIGCHI, since 2023